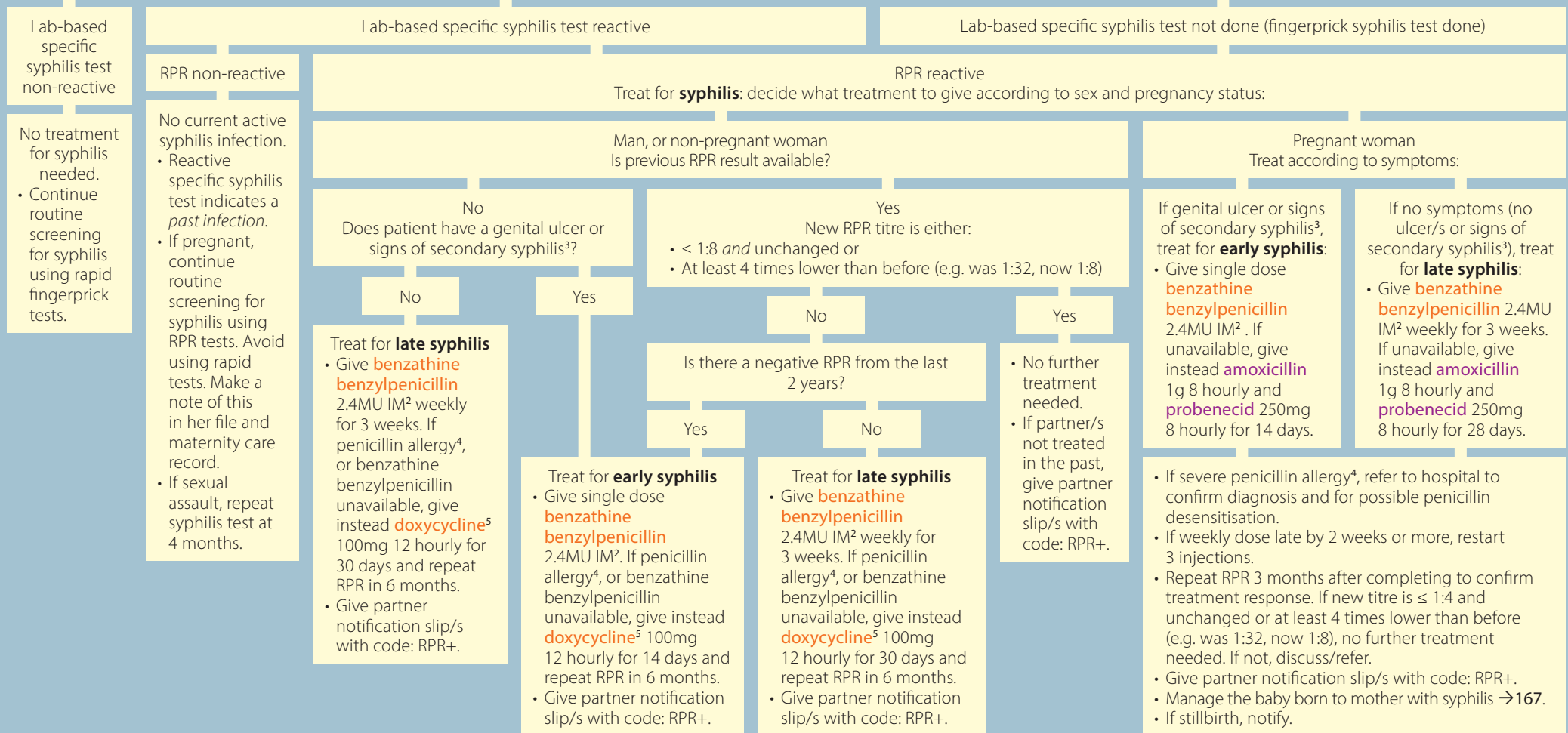


POSITIVE SYPHILIS RESULT

Approach to the patient with a positive syphilis result

- If fingerprick syphilis test¹ done and positive:
 - If any of the following, start treatment same day with **benzathine benzylpenicillin** 2.4MU IM²: pregnant, partner treatment, genital ulcer present, signs of secondary syphilis³ present.
 - Send blood for syphilis serology (RPR) to confirm result. On request form, write: "If RPR negative, do specific syphilis test on same specimen". Review in 1 week.

Manage according to results:



¹A rapid syphilis test remains positive for life, even if syphilis infection has been treated. If patient had previous positive rapid syphilis test result, avoid repeating rapid syphilis test. Send blood for syphilis serology (RPR) instead. ²For benzathine benzylpenicillin 2.4MU injection: dissolve **benzathine benzylpenicillin** 2.4 MU in 6mL **lidocaine 1%** without epinephrine (adrenaline). ³Secondary syphilis: 6-8 weeks after ulcer; generalised rash (includes palms/soles), flu-like symptoms, flat wart-like genital lesions, mouth ulcers, patchy hair loss. ⁴History of anaphylaxis, urticaria or angioedema. ⁵If breastfeeding, avoid doxycycline and refer.